TimeLex

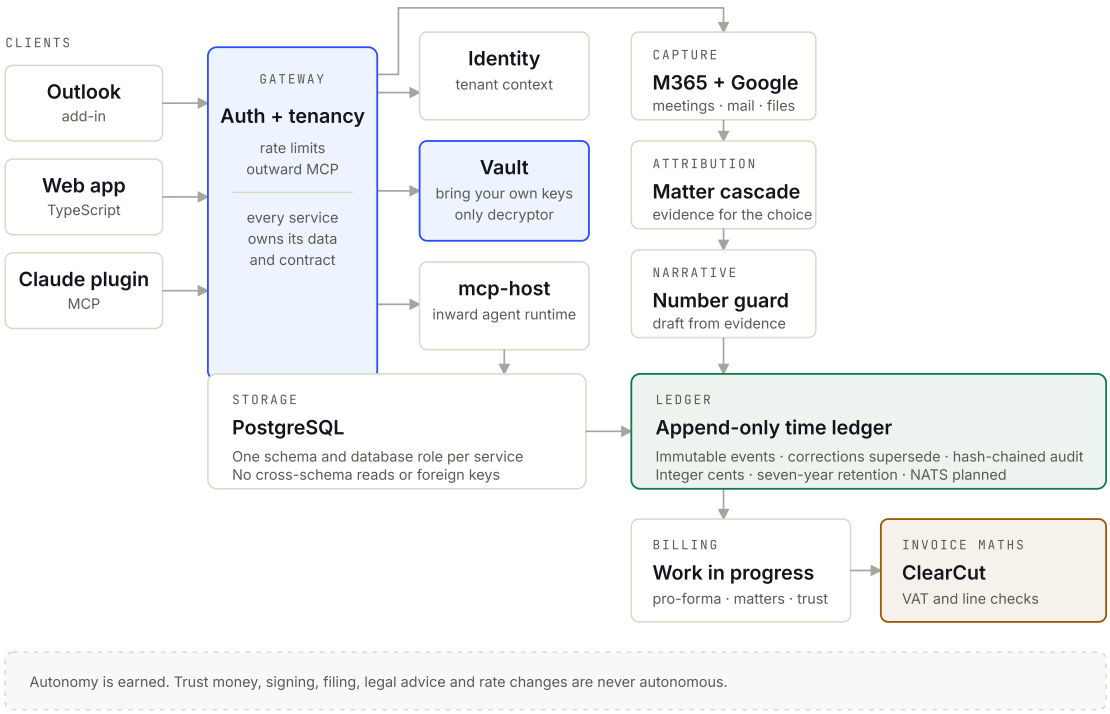
PRE-ALPHA, IN DEVELOPMENT

EXCEPTION-BASED PRACTICE MANAGEMENT

Autonomous, exception-based practice management for South African law firms. It captures work, attributes it to the right matter, writes the narrative and prepares the bill.

STATUS Pre-alpha, version 0.1.0	DATED 20 October 2026	ARCHITECTURE 12 services specified, 12 ADRs
GATES 9 phases with gates A, B and C	BUILT Walking skeleton	LICENCE Apache-2.0

ARCHITECTURE



Autonomy is earned. Trust money, signing, filing, legal advice and rate changes are never autonomous.

Clients enter through the gateway. Identity, vault and capture feed an append-only ledger, which drives billing and ClearCut for invoice maths.

SECURITY SURFACE · CAPTURE AND BILLING · APPEND-ONLY LEDGER

DECISIONS THAT SHAPED IT

ADR-0001 ACCEPTED

Service boundaries and contract-first microservices

A service exists only if it owns its data, has a versioned contract and differs in scaling, security or language. Every service exposes REST, MCP and a typed SDK from one codebase.

Why. A small team can build a distributed monolith by accident. Hard boundaries and a budget of four deployables through Phase 2 keep the system operable.

ADR-0005 ACCEPTED

Autonomy ladder and exception-based review

Five rungs from observe to autonomous to pre-bill. Auto-execution only when confidence meets a calibrated threshold, deterministic checks pass and policy allows.

Why. Trust money, signing, filing, legal advice and rate changes are never autonomous. The ladder makes that limit explicit instead of implied.

ADR-0006 ACCEPTED

Event-sourced activity and an append-only ledger

Activity events are immutable. Derived entries cite evidence, corrections supersede rather than overwrite, amounts are integer cents, the audit is hash-chained and retention has a seven-year floor.

Why. A bill must be explainable years later. An append-only record preserves what happened and why, even after a correction.

WHAT IS REAL, AND WHAT IS NOT

AREA	STATUS	NOTE
Live service	Not live	No public deployment. The repository is pre-alpha.
Built	Skeleton	Capture, attribution, ledger, billing and trust accounting are not built yet.
Data residency	At rest	Anthropic offers no African inference region, so residency claims apply to data at rest only (ADR-0007).
ADRs	7 accepted, 5 proposed	Proposed decisions are labelled as proposed on this page.
Licence	Apache-2.0	Source is public under Apache-2.0.
Claims	Designed	The autonomy ladder is a design commitment. It has not run in production.

STACK

Rust · Python · TypeScript · PostgreSQL · NATS JetStream (planned) · MCP · Outlook add-in · Claude plugin

LINKS

SOURCE	github.com/konethegreat/timelex
DOCS	github.com/konethegreat/timelex/blob/main/docs/ARCHITECTURE.md
STUDIO	k-one-it-solutions-website.erictshivhinda.workers.dev/
LICENCE	Apache-2.0